

gambling. You can also play around with your content to attract specific advertisements.

Mathew agrees that it is possible to tweak your content to attract high revenue ads. "If you keep playing around with your content to get such ads, you can be chucked out of the programme. But once you are out, there's no coming back," cautions Mathew.

On a more rational note, it's unwise to make your content advertisement-centric. "You risk losing your readers," says Kiruba Shankar, blogger, who runs www.kiruba.com—one of the most widely-read blogs in India. "I once had an ad for Sri Lankan tourism on my site—it attracted a lot of clicks, which gave me a decent sum. However, if I keep displaying ads on Lankan Tourism alone, how many readers would I get?" asks Kiruba.



Mastering The Game

The wisest thing to do is to stay focused on the content of your site/blog. Chances are, if people are interested in the data you're offering, they may be inclined to click those relevant links, which is actually what the ads really are. While, you're unable to determine what kind of ads show up on your page, you can filter out the ads that you do not want, say, competitors' ads.

You can include the Google search on your page, which is a good value-add to your site. Now, if you are wondering whether using AdSense increases the number of hits, the answer is "No, it doesn't". The bot that searches your site for content to place the ads is different from the one that visits your site to rate it on the search. Google has made sure that using AdSense is not a criterion for turning up high on the search results.



The Ayes And Nays

A clean, transparent, non-intrusive advertising service that let's you earn some shekels without investing a cent. That's probably why we have the Internet, right? Well, there are no free lunches, but this one comes really close. All the same, don't expect to generate all your revenue by using affiliate advertising services. It's good to have AdSense as it's free, though a high number of page-views is just what the doctor ordered.

If you are a Web site owner or a prolific blogger, it makes sense to have AdSense on your site as a secondary source of revenue

AdSense is a good instrument to supplement the income from your site. But if your Web site is your prime source of revenue, then you must consider other advertising and/or marketing sources. Mathew adds, "AdSense can't be the only source of revenue. We are also part of the Amazon Associates programme, and sell ad space on our site directly to companies."

If you are the owner of a Web site or are a prolific blogger, it's sensible to have AdSense as a supplementary source of revenue. Even popular sites like Indiatimes and Sify use AdSense. Don't expect to start with a five-figure packet using AdSense—a couple of thousands every month is more realistic and achievable.



Competitors Any?

There are other affiliate advertising programmes such as the Amazon Associates and the Yahoo Overture Affiliates. Nevertheless, users claim that Google's AdSense pays far more than any of these—as much as 35 per cent more. It has fewer caveats, and is prompt with payments.

Amazon Associates claim that the Amazon brand ends up getting a lot of visibility but doesn't necessarily translate into revenue for the Associates. AdSense, on the other hand, places ads of third parties so the relevance increases. Yahoo's Overture programme needs your site to have a very high number of page-views to get an approval. This is a major deterrent for smaller sites and bloggers.

On the flipside, in other affiliate programmes, the parent company provides you with the contact info of the person, who was referred by you and made a sale. This helps you in making future sales. However, AdSense does not give you this information. Still, this is of mere academic interest to most AdSense users who are by and large, small Web site owners or bloggers.

As a medium that places relevant text ads on your Web page or blog, AdSense is fast becoming the *de facto* advertising and sales tool for small time Web publishers. With rumours of how people have made \$1000 a day by using AdSense, hundreds more are queuing up. Don't lag behind—get ready to make that extra buck. ■

mithun_kidambi@jasubhai.com

Sensible Dos And Don'ts

Dos

- ▣ Keep the content of your site updated and relevant.
- ▣ If you have a blog, use publicising tools to publicise you are a blog. More readers mean more click-through rates, which translates to more revenue.
- ▣ Play up certain parts of your content if you think it would attract high revenue ads.
- ▣ Add the Google search to your Web page. It adds flexibility to your site, and increases page views.

Don'ts

- ▣ Don't tweak your site just to attract high revenue ads. Too much tweaking will bring you under the Google scanner and could lead to an ouster from the programme. Remember, the story of the goose that laid golden eggs?
- ▣ Don't go overboard and clutter your entire page with ads. You'll lose out on visitors.
- ▣ Don't hire some one to sit and click the ads on your site. This attracts automatic disqualification from the programme.
- ▣ Don't keep clicking the ads on your own page, obviously!

Reports

Account Information

Settings

Performance • Payment History

Reduced channels. Read more [here](#).

Channels. Click **Display Report** to view statistics for the selected criteria.

By

1

2004

Jan

2

2004

Aggregate data

Channel data

Active channels:

Homepage

Our channel

Banner ads

Purple skyscrapers

Press the control or option key to select multiple channels.

Channel

Both

Display Report

January 6, 2004

Download CSV file

Impressions	Clicks	Clickthrough rate	Your Earnings
1,840	57	3.0%	\$15.10
1,687	76	4.5%	\$12.25
2,120	52	2.4%	\$14.12
1,761	80	4.5%	\$14.15
7,408	265	2.8%	\$55.62

A typical AdSense payment report. See the \$55 (approx Rs. 2,365) earnings figure!